Can curiosity become purchase intention?

An exploratory academic study of Canadian adult consumers and four ant-protein product concepts.

74

Usable survey responses

After eligibility and completeness checks

4

Product concepts compared

Chips, powder, seasoning, whole ants

5

Student researchers

The Tenants | Group 10

RESEARCH WORKFLOW

01 Secondary research

Define the market question

02 Focus group

Explore language and barriers

03 Qualtrics survey

Test concepts and perceptions

04 SPSS analysis

Translate patterns into strategy

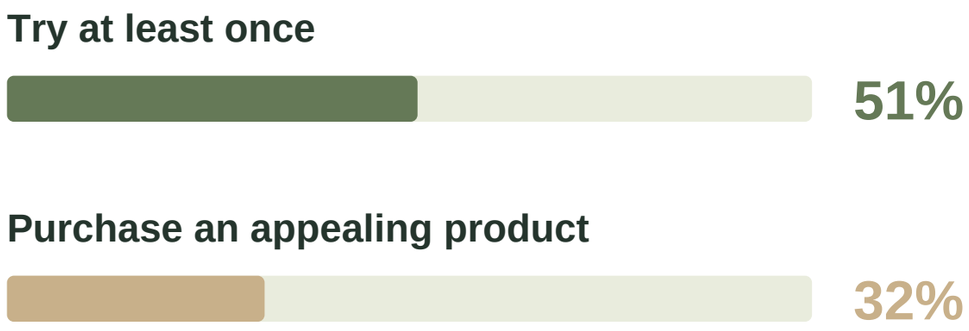
My contribution: moderated the focus group, helped synthesize qualitative insights, and co-developed the final recommendations and research limitations. Survey analysis and reporting were team deliverables.

Source: final research report dated August 30, 2026, and the team contribution record. Academic concept research; no product launch or sales outcome claimed.

Trial interest exceeded purchase intention.

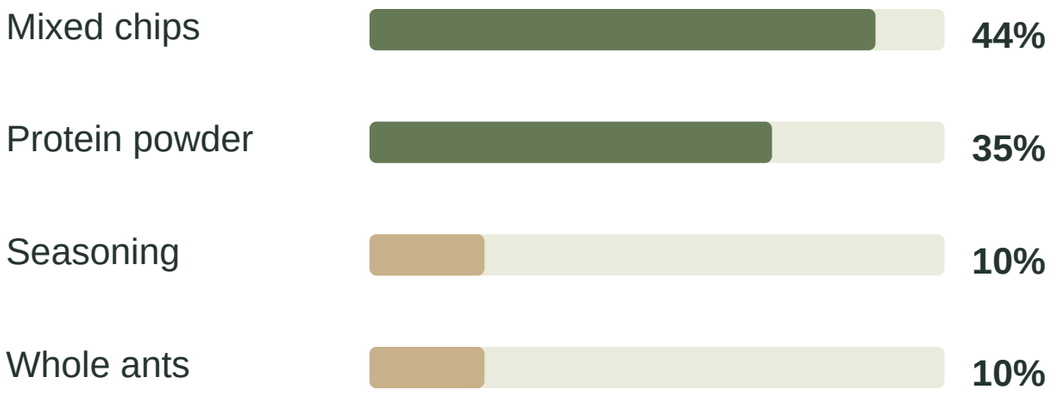
The distinction matters: curiosity about a novel food is not evidence of sustained demand.

STATED LIKELIHOOD



Somewhat, very, or extremely likely. Purchase scenario specified a reasonable price.

FIRST-CHOICE PRODUCT FORMAT



Team interpretation: prioritize familiar processed formats. Chips and powder were both promising concepts; their consideration ratings did not differ significantly (p = .50).

Source: final report, Consumer Awareness and Preferred Product Offering; Appendices A.2 and A.6-A.7. Percentages rounded; format shares total 99% due to rounding. Overall analytic n=74; paired trial/purchase n=73.

Reduce uncertainty around the food experience.

Sensory concerns and visible insects were the most frequently selected barriers in this sample.

REPORTED PURCHASE BARRIERS

Multiple selections allowed; percentages do not sum to 100%.

PACKAGING PRIORITIES

Food-safety information	7.12/10
Minimal insect imagery	6.43/10
Nutrition information	6.37/10
Sustainability messaging	5.10/10

Research insight: lower disgust had the strongest correlation with purchase intention (r = .59). This association identifies a testing priority; it does not establish causation.

Source: final report, Perceptions Associated With Purchase Intention and Preferred Product Offering; Appendices A.3-A.5 and A.8. Overall n=74; valid item counts varied. Packaging values are mean importance ratings.

Turn findings into testable next steps.

Recommendations developed by the team from the focus group and survey evidence.

01 Lead with familiar formats

Test mixed chips and protein powder before whole-ant products. Use familiar flavours and refine taste and texture.

02 Build reassurance into positioning

Prioritize clear food-safety information and taste. Reduce prominent insect imagery; verify any claims before use.

03 Recruit receptive early adopters

Explore food-adventurous consumers and people with prior insect-food experience. Test grocery and specialty retail concepts.

INTERPRETATION BOUNDARIES

Convenience sample: about 95% of respondents lived in British Columbia.

Concept-only exposure: respondents viewed product concepts, not a tasting experience.

Self-reported intentions: findings do not measure sales, repeat purchase, or national market demand.

Next step: validate through tasting studies, packaging experiments, and observed purchase behaviour before making commercial commitments.

Source: final report, Recommendations and Limitations. Portfolio summary credits team findings and Wells Suen's documented role. Participant details and student identifiers are omitted.